

HCI Design Challenge: Individual Reflection

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The assignment taught me how to use the HCI concepts learned in lectures and compulsory readings, and apply them to a real project. Starting early on in the semester allowed the iterative design process to happen naturally. Each lab throughout the year focussed on progressing the prototypes and the idea in general using different aspects of HCI.

In the first few weeks, we spent the time trying to home in on what the general idea of the app was going to be. We started with a general idea of helping secondary school students get to university, and specifically focussing on DEIS pupils as there was a noticeable inequality there.

When we settled on the idea for the AI chatbot, we moved on to rapid prototyping. We had sketches from the very beginning but then the iPhone templates helped us to come up with a more specific design for the interface. Doing this as a group in a short time span of less than an hour showed me how we can avoid the sunk cost fallacy and move through quite different ideas efficiently. We took the best aspects from everyone's individual work and proceeded from there.

Developing the personas was very helpful as it forced us to look at how the app should be used by different types of users, and what their expectations of the app might be. Rather than talking about the users as a vague ambiguous group, giving him a name and a face made it so that every decision we made was keeping "Dylan" in mind.

My individual role varied for the three main deliverables.

In the 8-minute presentation, I wrote the script for the first three sections: "The Problem", "The User", and "The Solution". I also did the slides for those three sections, as well as formatting the rest of the slideshow (but not its content). I put together the video, adding the music and captions, as well as editing the various clips that needed to be put together, including Nicole's live demonstration of the high-fidelity software prototype. I read one section in the narration of the video.

In the final paper, I wrote the abstract, Section 1: Introduction, Section 2: User Centred Design, Section 3: Requirements, Section 4: Goals, Section 5: Literature Review, Section 6: Alternative Design Considerations, and Section 10: References. I also put together the paper's appendix, as well as finding the proper ACM format so I could develop everything in LaTeX using Overleaf.

In the 5-minute prototype video, I wrote the script for the speakers, and put together the slideshow. I also put together the video and captions. I read one section in the narration of the video.